



MOUNTAIN WEATHER, TOLD STRAIGHT.

SNOWY MOUNTAINS, AU · WINTER 2026 OUTLOOK

What it feelzlike for winter in the Snowies.

A read on the season ahead. Cooler than last year on early models, with a wetter July than 2025. Opening weekend looks cold but light on snow, then a run of fronts from late June kicks the season into gear. July is shaping up as the month to book.

THE SEASON AT A GLANCE

JUNE

Opening run

Cold mornings, thin cover. Lifts spinning on machine-made snow opening weekend (7-9 Jun). First real fronts mid-month, mostly above 1,500m.

JULY

Peak month

School holidays, the busiest two weeks of the year. Multiple cold fronts forecast. Bases should hit 90-120cm by month end if the pattern holds.

AUGUST

Powder window

Historically the deepest snow. Storm cycles every 5-7 days on the long-range. Best chairs spinning, fewer crowds than July.

SEPTEMBER

Spring lap

Warmer days, soft afternoons. Lower runs patchy by mid-month. Closing weekend usually 4-5 Oct.

JULY SPOTLIGHT

July: the month it actually feelzlike winter.

Three to four cold fronts across the month on current modelling, with the biggest stretch landing in week two. Resort bases should sit 70-110cm for

most of the month. Book accommodation now — Jindabyne and Thredbo village are already 80% booked for the second week.

WED 1 TO SUN 5 JUL

Cold and clear. Groomers week.

High pressure parks over the range. Cold mornings (-8°C at 1,800m), bluebird most days. Snow-making running overnight. Good week for lessons and beginners.

New snow	5-10cm machine, no natural
Crowds	Light. Pre-school holidays.
Best for	Lessons, groomers, families

MON 6 TO SUN 12 JUL

School holidays kick off. First big front Thursday.

Busiest week of the season. Front rolls in Thursday afternoon, drops 25-40cm into Friday across Perisher and Thredbo. Saturday clears for a powder day. Book parking in advance.

New snow	30-45cm Thu-Fri
Crowds	Heavy. School holidays.
Best for	Powder Sat, all-mountain

MON 13 TO SUN 19 JUL

Holidays continue. Mid-week storm cycle.

Second front Tue-Wed brings 15-25cm. Cold throughout. Mid-week midweek will be the sweet spot — full lift access, fresh snow, and crowds easing slightly after the weekend.

New snow	20-30cm Tue-Wed
Crowds	Heavy weekend, easing midweek
Best for	Backcountry tours, all-mountain

MON 20 TO FRI 31 JUL

Crowds drop. Two more fronts on the way.

School holidays end. Locals and weekenders only. Two more fronts on long-range models around 22-23 Jul and 28-29 Jul. Bases peak for the season around 110-130cm. Best value week of the month.

New snow	20-35cm across the fortnight
Crowds	Quiet weekdays

Best for

Value, fresh tracks, longer days

MOUNTAIN BY MOUNTAIN

Perisher

Opens Sat 7 Jun

70-110cm by late July

Largest resort. Front Valley and Smiggins open first; Blue Cow and Guthega follow once cover holds.

Thredbo

Opens Sat 7 Jun

75-115cm by late July

Highest lifted terrain in Australia. Top-to-bottom skiing earlier than Perisher most years.

Selwyn

Opens Sat 14 Jun (planned)

30-50cm by late July

Lower elevation, family-focused. Snow-making expanded since the rebuild. Weekday only outside holidays.

Charlotte's Pass

Opens Sat 14 Jun

60-100cm by late July

Highest village in Australia. Snow-cat access only from Perisher Valley. Quiet. Often the best snow.

PLAN AHEAD

Lift passes

Buy multi-day before 30 Jun for early-bird pricing.

Accommodation

Jindabyne and Thredbo village 80% booked for week of 6 Jul.

Driving

Carry chains from 1 Jun. Alpine Way closes overnight if temps drop.

Backcountry

Avalanche risk briefings start 1 Jul on the alerts page.

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